

Segment 14 – Compeau Creek Rd to CR 550

(Formerly Segment #13), updated January 2025. [Google Map of Segment 14](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

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Segment length: About 1.9 miles, from south to north on this segment 278 ft of ascent, 458 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 42 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact the Trail Crew Leader (Bob Weisenberger, 906 361-4033, rweisenber@gmail.com) or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (for this segment, the trail description will be northbound, follow in reverse for southbound.)

This segment accesses several popular spurs, including Hogback Mountain and the Lily Pond. You will also cross a few rock outcroppings before glimpsing a view of Lake Superior.

From the parking area near (46.595039,-87.486550), you will head into the woods and follow the blue blazes as you climb, follow a short two track, spy the spur to the Lily Pond, and descend and climb again to the intersection of the Hogback Mountain spur. Hogback is a very popular but moderately challenging climb, requiring a little rock scrambling. The NCT continues to the right at this intersection. Play close attention to the blue blazes as there are numerous other trails and spurs that intersect. Once past the railroad grade, you will cross a bridge and then turn left to stay on the NCT. Twist, turns and climbs up and over rocks will eventually get you to the end of this segment at CR 550 (46.609924,-87.469560).

Driving Directions:

Southern Trailhead

From the corner of Wright St./Forestville Rd. head northwest on Forestville Rd for approximately 1.6 miles. Turn right (this continues to be Forestville Rd.) and immediately cross the railroad tracks and continue for .3 miles. Take the first left (still Forestville Rd.) and continue for 1.2 miles. Turn right and when this road ends, turn right and there is parking just to the left. [Driving map from Wright St/Forestville Rd to Compeau Creek Rd](#).

Northern Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for 4.8 miles on Hawley St. which turns into [County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd]. Watch for signs for the NCT crossing. There is no actual parking area but there is a little pull off where the trail crosses [CR 550/Big Bay Rd] just before the guardrail. For those who prefer to follow a GoogleMap, here is [Driving map from Lakeshore Blvd/Wright St to parking on CR 550](#). This is a very busy road so be sure to pull as far off as possible. The segment can also be combined with Segment 15, which has a better parking area.

Camping:

Camping is not allowed on this segment. The homeowners to the west do have rustic cabins to rent.. [Hipcamp - Bear Tree Homestead](#). The State of MI property has rustic DNR cabins that they rent. [Little Presque Isle Cabins](#)

Water Access:

Water is available at Compeau Creek at (46.594788,-87.487006).

Seasonal Access Information:

The southern trailhead is best avoided in the wintertime; the road is very narrow with limited snowplowing and parking can be non-existent. The rest of the year it is best in an AWD. The northern trailhead on CR 550 is reachable year-round, although it may be difficult to park far enough off the road during the winter.